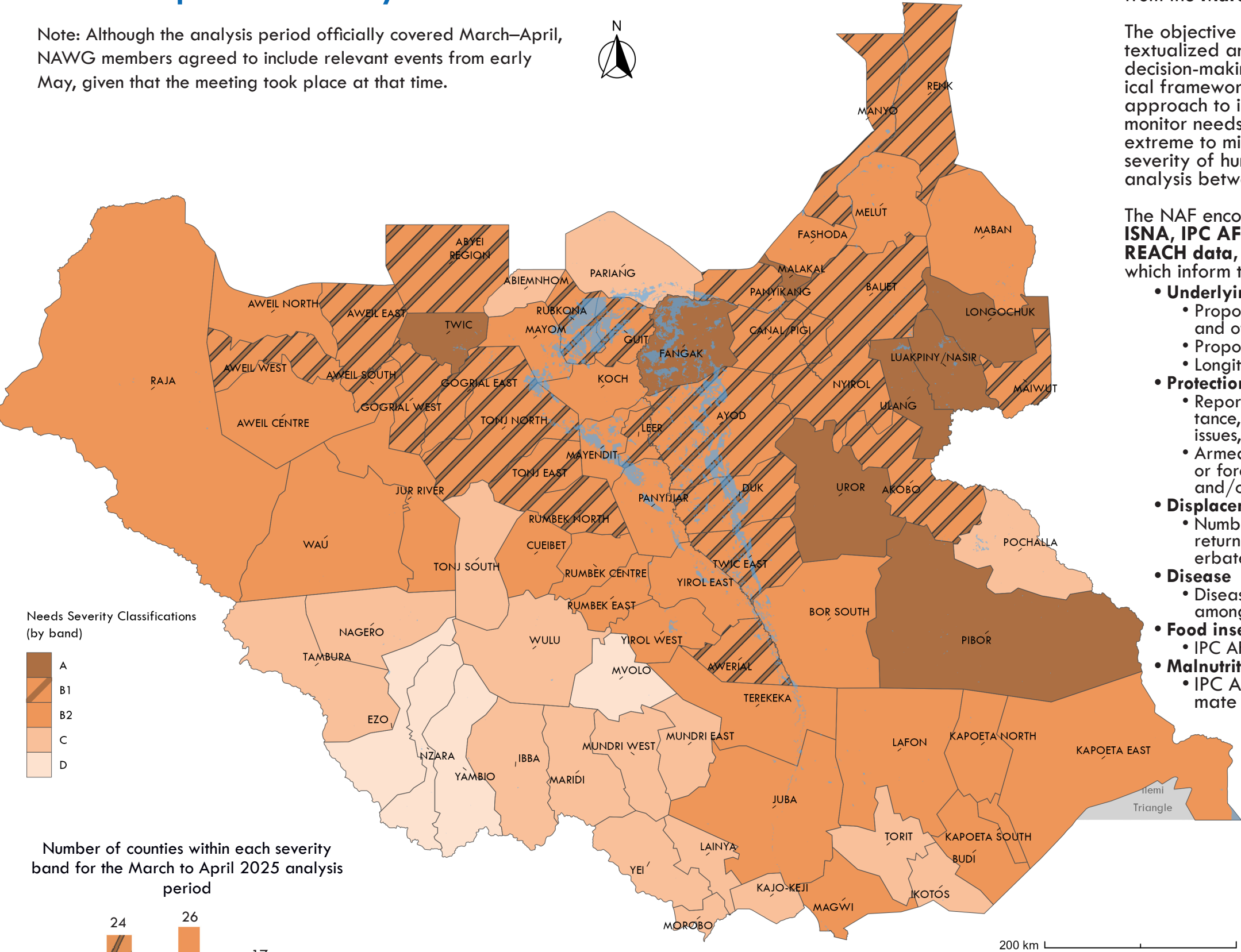


SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

March - April 2025 Analysis

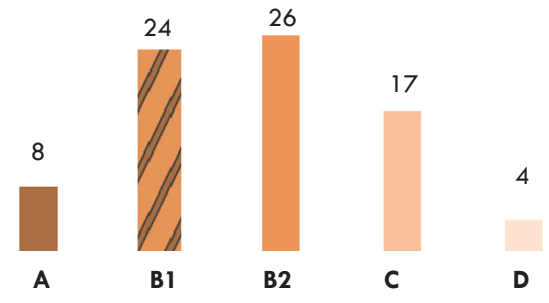
Note: Although the analysis period officially covered March–April, NAWG members agreed to include relevant events from early May, given that the meeting took place at that time.



Needs Severity Classifications (by band)



Number of counties within each severity band for the March to April 2025 analysis period



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Felix Omuu (omuu@un.org) or Rebecca Hetzer (rebecca.hetzer@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on May 6th, 2025 to discuss the analysis from the **March to April** period.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of essential needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including **FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH data, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, PRMS, and data from Clusters**) which inform the following indicators:

- **Underlying vulnerability**
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- **Protection**
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- **Displacement**
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- **Disease**
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- **Food insecurity**
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- **Malnutrition**
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used to estimate crude mortality

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

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Counties facing “extreme” humanitarian conditions

Based on the backend analysis, six counties were initially classified as ‘Band A’, namely: **Pibor, Nasir, Longochuk, Twic, Malakal, and Uror**.

Following in-depth discussion and contextual analysis during the NAWG meeting, **Ulang** and **Fangak** were ultimately also classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A).

Discussion and joint analysis

- **Ulang:** Flagged due to food insecurity projected, ongoing clashes causing widespread displacement, increased disease rates (including a cholera outbreak), and a critical lack of mitigating factors, including reportedly missed food distributions. Health facilities have been attacked, and insecurity is hampering the provision of assistance, including health and vaccination campaigns. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A.**
- **Fangak:** Flagged due to severe underlying vulnerability and projected food insecurity, indicating extreme levels of need. A REACH Integrated Public Health Assessment conducted in March found signs of IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) acute food insecurity among sampled returnees in Old Fangak. On May 3rd, Old Fangak Town reportedly experienced several aerial bombardments, during which a humanitarian medical facility sustained damage, and seven people were reportedly killed, with 27 injured. Displacement followed incidents on May 3rd and 4th from both Old and New Fangak, with partners following up; initial reports suggest over 20,000 people were displaced after the second attack. Aerial bombardments continued in early May, with the latest reported attack occurring on May 10th. Considering early May incidents, Fangak was classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B1 to Band A.**
- **Panyikang:** Flagged due to projected food insecurity; ongoing tensions, particularly around Tonga; reported displacement into Malakal and Fashoda following clashes in April; reported airstrikes in Odong on May 5; and reports of very high levels of acute malnutrition. Limited WASH services further elevate the risk of cholera. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1, added to close monitoring.**
- **Canal/Pigi:** Flagged due to shelling and reported armed youth positions in multiple locations (Kaldak, Lelo, Atar, Diel, Owachi) in April. The humanitarian situation is similar to that of Panyikang, with significant accessibility issues and limited partner presence. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B1.**

- **Baliet:** Flagged due to projected food insecurity and an IPC Phase 5 (Catastrophe) classification for Acute Malnutrition (AMN) in the IPC second projection period (April-June 2025). Recent health data from partners point to an increasing number of cholera cases in Akoka (48 cases reported in early May), prompting an upscale in cholera response. **Final classification: Elevated from Band B2 to Band B1, and added to close monitoring.**
- **Juba:** Flagged due to the influx of 3,952 people into Juba IDP camps in March amidst high tensions and violence within Juba County. **Final classification: Maintained in Band B2.**
- **Abiemnhom:** Flagged due to fighting in April, which displaced a total of 14,000 people to Ajakuaj Payam and other areas; of these, 9,000 have since returned. Notably, on April 2, some 7,020 individuals—including 900 children under two—were displaced from Abiemnhom to Abyei. **Final classification: Maintained in Band C.**
- **Kajo Keji, Morobo, Yei, Lainya (Central Equatoria):** Flagged due to increased tensions which forced an unconfirmed number of people to flee for safety, with some moving towards the Ugandan border. Shelling was reported in Morobo and Lainya Counties on May 1st, and clashes occurred in Yei on May 4th. As of last week, approximately 11,000 IDPs were sheltered in Morobo, including in schools and churches where partners reportedly provided rapid response. **Final classification: Maintained all four counties in Band C; Morobo added to close monitoring.**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. **Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.**

- **Pibor (Band A):** Continued monitoring required due to projected pockets of IPC AFI Phase 5 (Catastrophe) for April – July, according to IPC analysis conducted in September 2024. Specific and grave concerns were raised for Eastern Pibor, especially Boma and Maruwo, given that the main supply route has been inaccessible since April 2024. Furthermore, humanitarian food assistance reportedly will not reach these areas until July at the earliest. Gumuruk and Lekuangle payams in Western Pibor were also identified as areas of concern, with an inaccessible road network and casualties reported due to an ongoing cholera outbreak.
- **Nasir (Band A):** Continued monitoring required due to projected food insecurity, ongoing tensions, and reports of significant population displacement. Health and shelter responses are reportedly being conducted through local partners, indicating that while access is still minimal,

it may have improved slightly.

- **Longochuk (Band A):** Continued monitoring required due to projected food insecurity, ongoing tensions, and reported displacement.
- **Twic (Band A):** Continued monitoring required due to the county hosting a significant number of IDPs from Abiemnhom (20,524) and returnees from Sudan (4,890). This influx puts additional strain on an already critical food-security situation, as Twic recorded a Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) rate of 25.5 percent, according to the September 2024 IPC analysis, which is well above the 15 percent emergency threshold.
- **Malakal (Band A):** Continued monitoring required due to projected pockets of IPC AFI Phase 5 (Catastrophe) for April – July, according to IPC analysis conducted in September 2024. Two recent SMART surveys conducted in Malakal County and the Malakal PoC show GAM rates nearing “extremely critical” thresholds consistent with IPC Acute Malnutrition Phase 5. Furthermore, an ongoing cholera outbreak and a reported Mpox outbreak further escalate public health risks.
- **Uror (Band A):** Continued monitoring required due to IPC projections expecting pockets of IPC AFI Phase 5 (Catastrophe) conditions between April and July.
- **Tonj East (Band B1):** Flagged due to persistent communal conflict, cattle raiding impacting supplies, existing food insecurity (25% cereal production deficit), and reported scaled-back partner operations.
- **Gogrial West (Band B1):** Flagged due to the ongoing cholera outbreak and a reported influx of IDPs from Abiemnhom with acute needs. A recent IRNA report indicated a need for food distribution and planting materials.
- **Abyei (Band B1):** Flagged for close monitoring following fighting on April 2nd in Abiemnhom town, which led to an influx of IDPs into Eastern Abyei (Juljok). IOM DTM registered 7,161 individuals (1,428 households), including 887 children under two years, in Juljok. A joint assessment mission highlighted an evolving and worsening humanitarian situation. Following fires reported in Amiet market in both January and February, a more recent fire in the market reportedly extended to the host community, affecting hundreds of 300 homes. Partners are requested to share further information.
- **Tonj North (Band B1):** Flagged due to an ongoing cholera outbreak (532 cases, 18 deaths reported as of April 25th), livestock diseases, communal conflicts, and scaled-back partner operations reportedly due to funding cuts and insecurity.